

Boeing B-17 Flying Fortress



THE WARTIME MODELS of the Boeing B-17 – the B-17C, D, E, F, and G – were extraordinary fighting machines. Also known as the “Flying Fortress,” the B-17 was bristling with machine guns, could fly at an altitude of over 30,000ft (9,000m), and – when in mass formation – was capable of delivering a staggering tonnage of explosives. In clear weather, the sophisticated Norden bombsight allowed the B-17 to strike a relatively small target, otherwise the USAF came to rely on blind bombing techniques.

For the B-17’s crew of 10, conditions were cramped and uncomfortable. The aircraft was not

“The B-17 was a very sturdy, easy-to-fly airplane that would take lots of damage and get you home...”

DICK ATKINS

USAAF PILOT

Hamilton Standard propeller

Viewing panel for aiming bombs

Plexiglas nose

Navigation light

Outer wing panel

Remote-controlled chin turret

Deicing strip

Fabric-covered rudder

TURBO ENGINES

The B-17G had four turbo-supercharged engines, each with a 11ft 6in (3.5m) diameter propeller. This enabled it not only to carry a heavy bombload but also to cruise at high altitude.

Specifications (B-17G)

ENGINES 4 x 1,200hp Wright R-1820 air-cooled radial with General Electric B-22 turbo-supercharger

WINGSPAN 103ft 9in (31.6m)

LENGTH 74ft 4in (22.7m)

WEIGHT 36,135lb (16,391kg)

TOP SPEED 302mph (486kph) **CREW** 10

ARMAMENT 13 x M-2 Browning .5in machine guns; 6,000lb (2,724kg) bombload

Handheld waist gun

Rudder trim tab

Tail gun turret

Tailwheel

Twin Browning machine guns

